



UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE
HO CHI MINH CITY

Networking

Adapted from Quinn's Slides

Nguyen V. Vu

Spring 2021

Outline

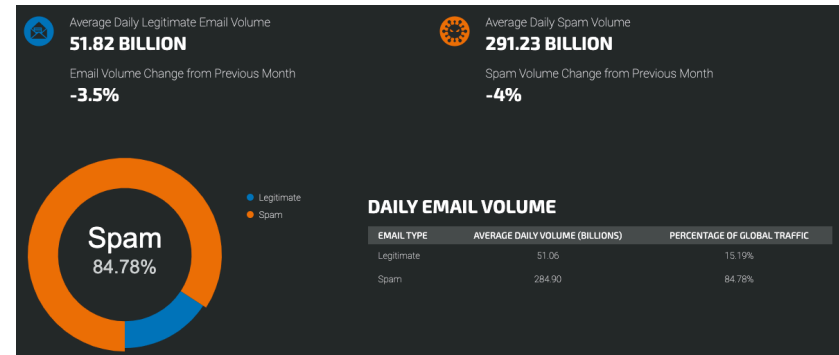
- Email and spam
- Fighting spam
- World Wide Web
- Ethical perspectives on pornography
- Censorship
- Freedom of expression
- In-class exercise

Introduction

- [illegible]

The Spam Epidemic (1/2)

- Spam: Unsolicited, bulk email
- Amount of email that is spam has increased
 - ❑ 8% in 2001
 - ❑ 40% in 2003
 - ❑ 75% in 2007
- Spam is effective
 - ❑ More than 100 times cheaper than “junk mail”
 - ❑ Profitable even if only 1 in 100,000 buys product



Source: https://talosintelligence.com/reputation_center/email_rep

The Spam Epidemic (2/2)

- How firms get email addresses
 - ❑ Opt-in lists
 - ❑ Dictionary attacks
- Spammers seek anonymity
 - ❑ Change email and IP addresses to disguise sending machine
 - ❑ Hijack another system as a spam launch pad
- Spam blockers
 - ❑ Attempt to screen out spam
 - ❑ Have led to more picture-based spam

Ethical Evaluations of Spamming

- Kantian evaluation
- Act utilitarian evaluation
- Rule utilitarian evaluation
- Social contract theory evaluation
- From all these perspectives, it is wrong to send spam

Fighting Spam

- Proposed solutions to the spam epidemic
- CAN SPAM Act of 2003
- Emergence of “spim”
- Vietnam: 90/2008/NĐ-CP Decree
 - Nghị định chính phủ Về chống thư rác

Proposed Solutions to Spam Epidemic

- Require an explicit opt-in of subscribers
- Require labeling of email advertising
- Add a cost to every email that is sent
- Ban unsolicited email
- Spam filters (technology)

CAN SPAM Act of 2003

- Took effect January 1, 2004
 - ❑ Consumers have right to “opt out”
 - ❑ Sexually explicit messages must contain subject line notice
 - ❑ Prohibits dictionary attacks and falsifying header information
- Spammers can avoid prosecution by locating outside United States

Vietnam's Decree 90/2008/NĐ-CP

- Took effect 8/2008
 - ❑ No individual or organization can send spams without consent from receivers (opt in)
 - ❑ Only ad providers can send spams without consent
 - ❑ People must be allowed to opt out
 - ❑ [QC]

Emergence of “Spim”

- “Spim” is an unsolicited, bulk instant message
- Quite serious in Vietnam
 - Mobile users are often charged per message by operators
 - 90/2008/NĐ-CP decree can be applied
- People combat spim by accepting messages only from friends or buddies

The WWW

■ Benefits

- ❑ Shopping
- ❑ Contributing content (wikis, blogs)
- ❑ Promoting business
- ❑ Learning
- ❑ Exploring our roots
- ❑ Paying taxes
- ❑ Gambling
- ❑ Etc.

■ Attributes

- ❑ It is decentralized
- ❑ Every Web object has a unique address
- ❑ It is based on the Internet

Too Much Control or Too Little?

- Not everyone in world has Internet access
- Saudi Arabia: centralized control center
- People's Republic of China: ISPs sign “self-discipline” agreement
- Germany: Forbids access to neo-Nazi sites
- United States: Repeated efforts to limit access of minors to pornography
- Vietnam: politically-deemed sensitive websites blocked
 - Facebook was blocked often

Direct Censorship

- Government monopolization
- Prepublication review
- Licensing and registration



Image: comparitech.com

Self-censorship

- Most common form of censorship
- Group decides for itself not to publish
- Reasons
 - Avoid subsequent persecution
 - Maintain good relations with government officials (sources of information)
- Ratings systems
 - Movies, TVs, CDs, video games
 - **Not** the Web
- Do you self-censor yourself?

Challenges Posed by the Internet

- Many-to-many communication
- Dynamic connections
- Huge numbers of Web sites
- Extends beyond national borders, laws
- Can't determine age of users

Facebook's content moderation

- Facebook has almost 2 billion users
- Facebook has been criticized for not censoring sex, terrorism, and violence content
- It has 4,500 content moderators and plans to hire 3,000 more
- The Guardian has just revealed Facebook's secret guidance for moderators on filtering sex, terrorism, and violence content

Facebook's policy on violence

Credible Violence

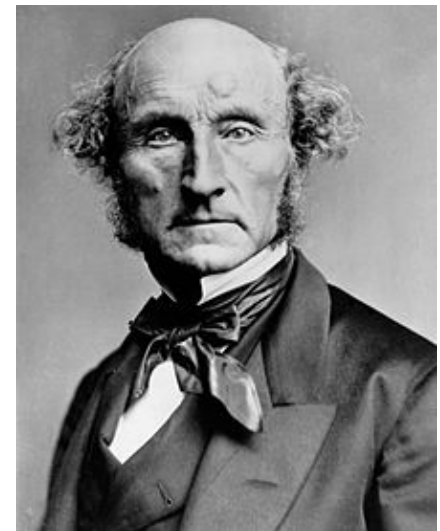
- Calls for Action

- "Someone shoot Trump". ✗
- "Kick a person with red hair". ✓
- "To snap a bitch's neck, make sure to apply all your pressure to the middle of her throat". ✓
- "Let's beat up fat kids". ✓
- #stab and become the fear of the Zionist. ✗

- remove
- ok
- Source: Guardian

Ethical Perspectives on Censorship

- Immanuel Kant opposed censorship
 - Enlightenment thinker
 - “Have courage to use your own reason”
- John Stuart Mill opposed censorship
 - No one is infallible
 - Any opinion may contain a kernel of truth
 - Truth revealed in class of ideas
 - Ideas resulting from discourse are more influential



Mill's Principle of Harm

- “The only ground on which intervention is justified is to prevent harm to others; the individual’s own good is not a sufficient condition.”

1st Amendment to U.S. Constitution



- “Congress shall make **no law** respecting an establishment of **religion**, or prohibiting the free exercise thereof; or abridging the **freedom of speech**, or of the press; or the right of the people peaceably to assemble, and to petition the government for a redress of grievances.”

Freedom of Expression

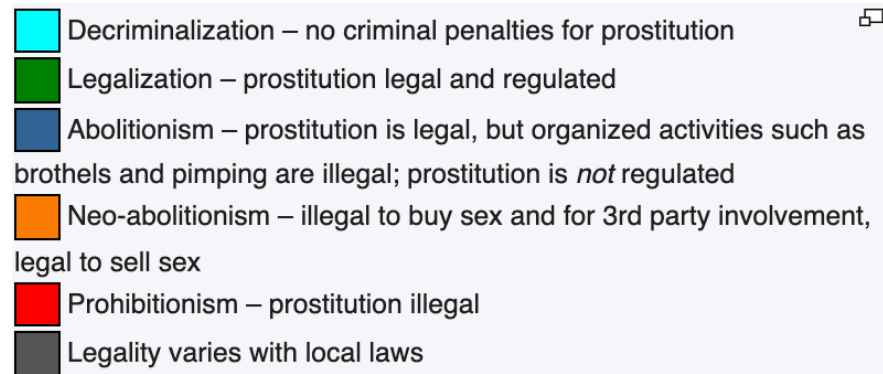
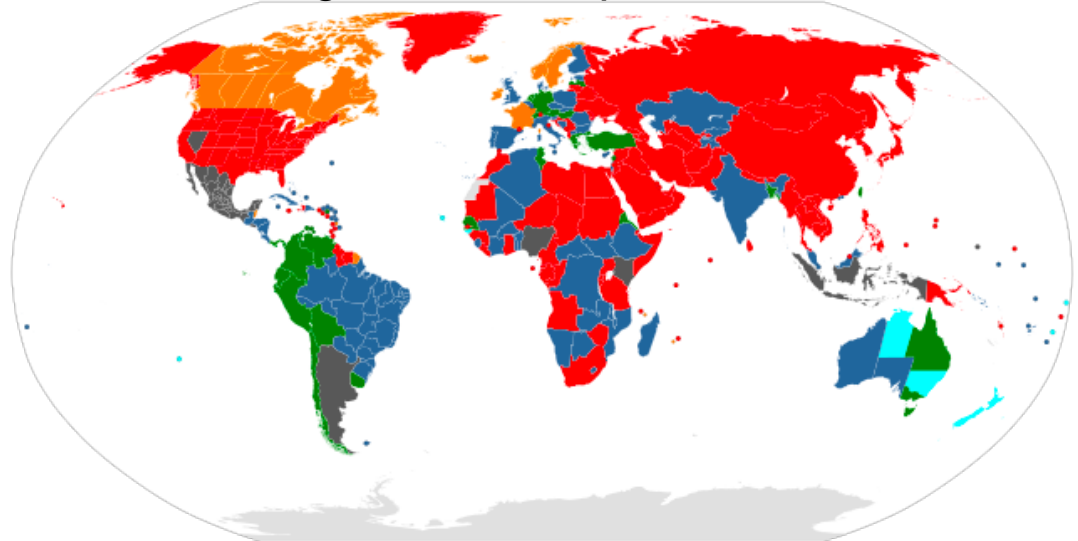
Not an Absolute Right

- 1st Amendment of the U.S. Constitution covers political and nonpolitical speech
- Right to freedom of expression must be balanced against the public good
- Various restrictions on freedom of expression exist

Pornography Discussion

- Is pornography moral?
- Should Vietnam legalize prostitution?

Legal status on prostitution



Source: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Prostitution_law

Pornography Is Immoral

■ Kant

- ❑ Loved person an object of sexual appetite
- ❑ Sexual desire focuses on body, not complete person
- ❑ All sexual gratification outside marriage wrong

■ Utilitarianism

- ❑ Pornography reduces dignity of human life
- ❑ Pornography increases crimes such as rape
- ❑ Pornography reduces sympathy for rape victims
- ❑ Pornography is like pollution
- ❑ Pornography industry diverts resources from more socially redeeming activities

Adult Pornography Is Moral

■ Utilitarianism

- ❑ Those who produce pornography make money
- ❑ Consumers of pornography derive physical pleasure
- ❑ Pornography is a harmless outlet for exploring sexual fantasies

■ Many countries legalize pornography

FCC v. Pacifica Foundation et al.

- George Carlin records “Filthy Words”
- WBAI in New York airs “Filthy Words” (1973)
- FCC issues declaratory order to Pacifica
- Pacifica sues
- U.S. Supreme Court ruled FCC did not violate 1st Amendment (5-4 decision)
 - Broadcast media “uniquely pervasive”
 - Broadcasting uniquely accessible to children

Web Filters

- Web filter: software that prevents display of certain Web pages
 - May be installed on an individual PC
 - ISP may provide service for customers
- Methodologies
 - Maintain “black list” of objectionable sites
 - Examine content for objectionable words/phrases

Identity Theft

- Identity theft
 - when a person uses another person's electronic identity
 - Leading form: credit card fraud
- Many victims are experienced computer users comfortable with typing credit card number online

Chat Room Predators

- Chat room: supports real-time discussions among many people connected to network
- Instant messaging and chat rooms replacing telephone for many people
- Some pedophiles meeting children through chat rooms
- Police countering with “sting” operations

Ethical Evaluations of “Stings”

- Utilitarian evaluation
- Kantian evaluation
- Social contract theory evaluation

False Information

- Quality of Web-based information varies widely
- Other media also have information of varying quality
 - *The New York Times v. The National Enquirer*
 - *60 Minutes v. Conspiracy Theory*
- Google attempts to reward quality
 - Ranking uses “voting” algorithm
- Fake news has become a serious problem recently

Discussion

- How do you filter fake news or information from real one?
- Related: check out the ways of fallacies (ngụy biện)

In-Class Exercise

- Solicited and Unsolicited SMS (Spim) is a popular direct marketing form in Vietnam. Mobile users are even changed when receiving SMS
- From groups representing advertisers, mobile operators, and consumers to debate the value and morality of the direct SMS marketing. What should the government do?

In-Class Exercise 2

- Social networks are now popular, almost all of us use them, esp. Facebook
- Do you have any agenda in sharing, commenting, liking things on social networks?
- Discuss the use of social networks in sharing, commenting, liking
- Do we take responsibility for the content we share?
- Do we take responsibility for the false content we share?